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Right Node Raising: (Why) Have We Moved On From Movement?

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Abstract

This article scrutinizes the most commonly and repeatedly given arguments levied against a movement analysis of right node raising. I argue that these arguments do not hold up, by showing either that the empirical evidence has either been mis-analyzed, or carry little to no weight give empirical and theoretical advances that have developed since the arguments against a movement analysis were initially made. After diffusing the arguments against a movement analysis, I sketch out an analysis of right node raising involving *multidomnant syntax*. Analyses of right node raising that have adopted a representation involving multiple dominance structure have, erroneously in my view, equated such analysis with an *in-situ* (=no movement) analysis (McCawley 1982). This is no longer the case given the current landscape of theorizing about the representation of movement, in which multidominance and movement are more or less coterminous (the former is a means for representing the later) rather than conceptually distinct.

Keywords: right node raising, across the board movement, ellipsis, multidominant syntax

1 Introduction

The construction known as *Right Node Raising* (RNR), exemplified by example (1), has been subject to a number of analyses and controversies.

(1) Everyone hates, but nobody speaks out against, the inefficiency of the administration.

Among the analyses that a majority of recent works reject is an analysis of RNR as Across-the-Board (ATB) rightward movement (Ross 1967, Postal 1996, Sabbagh 2007). The aim of this article is to critically evaluate the many repeatedly cited arguments rejecting this analysis (hereafter, the *movement* analysis) (see, e.g., Abels (2004), Wilder (2008),Bachrach &Katzir (2009), Barros & Vicente 2011). This article will heavily refer to a recent article in this journal by Belk, Neelman, and Philps (BNLP 2023). This article is not, however, intended to directly refute any specific proposals introduced in BNP. Instead, BNP serves primarily as a proxy for a great number of works on the topic of RNR which, like BNP, take the position (implicitly or explicitly) that a movement analysis is untenable. BNP is a sensible piece of work to reply to because it summarizes a majority of the arguments that have been repeatedly used to militate against such an analysis.

Section 2 of this paper scrutinizes the oft-cited arguments for rejecting the movement analysis of RNR. I hope to demonstrate that these arguments are made of straw. Section 3 of the paper suggests a path forward in terms of (re-)analyzing RNR as an instance of multidominant syntax (parallel merge), which is compatible with movement (=internal re-merge). This possibility is overlooked in BNP and other works, where multidomiance is equated (falsely, I believe) with an *in-situ* analysis that is incompatible with Movement. Current theorizing about structure building and multidominance open up the possibility that structures involving multiple-dominance are compatible with, and even intimately connected to, Movement. Section 4 concludes the article.

2 Six Arguments Against a Movement Analysis of RNR

The quotation below, which appears early on in Belk, Neelman, and Phillip (BNP, 2023), makes it clear that the authors summarily reject a Rightward-ATB (movement) analysis of RNR.

> "Given these considerations, we do not pursue a movement analysis of RNR."
> (BNP 2023:689)

The extent to which BLP are faithful to not pursuing a movement analysis is based on 6 empirical challenges[1] to all analyses of RNR, which–without much critical discussion–they mainly presuppose are fatal problems for an analysis of RNR involving Movement.

[1]There is a seventh argument that BNP deal with, Cumulative agreement (described and analyzed in detail by Grosz 2015) which I will not discuss in this article.

These are: (i) Order Preservation; (ii) Islands insensitivity; (iii) Non-rebracketing; (iv) Mismatches; (v) Vehicle change; and (vi) Internal readings (wide scope). I discuss each of these "arguments" in the subsections below. For a bit of context first, BNP compare three commonly contrasted analyses of RNR with respect to their relative success or lack of success in accounting for each of the empirical domains just mentioned: (I) Movement; (II) Deletion/Ellipsis; and (III) Multi-dominance. In addition, they compare dual analyses in which two of these unitary analyses are combined.

Table 1: Overview of the empirical coverage of unitary and dual analyses of right-node raising

		Movement	Ellipsis	M-dominance	Movement+ ellipsis	Movement+ m-dominance	Ellipsis+ m-dominance
a.	Order preservation	✘	✔	✔	✘	✘	✔
b.	Island sensitivity	✘	✔	✔	✔	✔	✘
c.	Non-rebracketing	✘	✔	✔	✘	✘	✔
d.	Mismatches	✘	✔	✘	✔	✘	✔
e	Vehicle change	✘	✔	✘	✔	✘	✔
f.	Internal readings	✘	✘	✔	✘	✔	✔

As one can see from BNP's table, they conclude that an analysis of RNR that involves *Movement* fails all of the tests of empirical adequacy. As is also clear, they end up concluding along with Barros and Vicente (2011) that an analysis of RNR that is empirically adequate requires both Ellipsis and Multi-Dominance. In the remarks below, I critically access whether their conclusion with respect to a movement analysis is warranted. To foreshadow the general conclusion, I argue that the problems that they raise for movement are made of straw, and that–while their arguments are superficially logical–there is often little substance to them once greater care is taken to unpack the premises of these arguments given the wider context of our contemporary understanding of the empirical domain from which they are formed.

2.1 Island (In)sensitivity

Virtually all work on RNR, especially those which reject a movement analysis, cite an argument from Wexler & Cullicover (1980) that a movement analysis incorrectly predicts that the RNR-pivot (=the shared element) should not be able to associate with a position contained within an island (i.e., that it should show the same ungrammaticality effects of leftward movement out of an island). A typical example illustrating the nature of the problem is given in (2) and (3). Example (2) illustrates the well-known sensitivity of leftward-movement out of a relative clause, while example (3) is intended to demonstrate that apparent (ATB-)rightward movement does not show the same sensitivity to islands.[2]

[2]Bacharach & Katzir (2009:283) actually state that examples like (2) are grammatical, as long as the gap is rightmost within each conjunct. They therefore claim that example (2) is grammatical, while (i) is not:

(i) *Who did a man who [loves ___ dance], and a woman who [hates __ go home]?

I have seen no repeated claims about grammaticality subsequent to Bachrach & Katzi's work. I concur that

(2) (*)Which book did Fred met the woman who wrote ___ and the critic who reviewed ___?

(3) Fred met the woman who wrote ___ and the critic who reviewed ___ that article about the failings of the administration.

While this argument may have been convincing at the time and in the context of Wexler & Cullicover's work, nothing in the context of contemporary research on islands would make this argument meaningful any longer. This was the major point of Sabbagh's (2007) work on RNR.

In that work, Sabbagh adopts the working hypothesis of Fox & Pesetsky (2001) that all or at least a subset of the islands (e.g., *Wh*-islands, etc.) can be explained as a consequence of Cyclic Spell-Out and the hypothesis that island sensitivity emerges as a result of a constrain on linearization. In brief, linear order must be preserved over multiple stages of a derivation, and failure to meet this condition is the source of island sensitivity. At that time, this was a reasonable theory of islands, and–crucially–one that *independently* predicted sensitivity to islands for leftward movement movement *but not* for (string-vacuous) rightward movement.[3] As other attempts to develop a unified theory of islands were no longer being pursued, it should also have been clear that use of islands as a diagnostic for movement would have to be handled critically and with great care. Most contemporary work presumes that there is not a single 'unified' explanation for the full set of islands initially discussed by Ross (1967). Therefore, the use of (in)sensitivity to islands as a diagnostic for movement is only useful only in so far as we have an understanding of the nature and origin of the islands itself.[4]

My main point is this: Use of an island or islands as a diagnostic for movement is fruitless unless the island(s) being used are coupled with an explicit theory of those islands that exists independently of the construction that island (in)sensitivity is being used for or to diagnose. To further appreciate the issue, let us first consider the Coordinate Structure Constraint (CSC), and then the so called *Wh*-island constraint.

2.1.1 RNR and the CSC As Sabbagh (2007) observes, RNR appears to be sensitive to the CSC. Consider the following example (see also, Postal 1998:122).

(4) *Josh was looking for ___, Mary was waiting in the Dean's office, and reporters were trying to find ___, the person responsible for the protest.

If RNR is insensitive to *all* islands (as BNP and others have assumed), then it should be insensitive to the CSC and examples like (4) ought to be grammatical. This is plainly the wrong outcome, and the fact that sentence (4) is ungrammatical should lnstead lead one to

(i) is indeed (sharply) ungrammatical compared to (2) (putting aside the obvious typos relating to the correct inflection), but for the sake of argument assume that examples like (2) are ungrammatical as well since this seems to be the most agreed upon judgment cited in the literature.

[3]This prediction was not explicitly pointed out in Fox & Pesetsky (2001), but plainly followed from their system.

[4]See, for example, Pesetsky (2013).

conclude that RNR is sensitive to at least one Island. Moreover, the CSC, as is well known, constrains leftward (ATB-)movement as well. Example (5) is as ill-formed as example (4).

(5) *Which protestor was Josh looking for ___, Mary was sitting in the Dean's office, and reporters were trying to find ___?

It is crucial here that both sentences (4) and (5) are ungrammatical (the presumption being that the source of their ungrammaticality is traceable to a single constraint that does not differentiate leftward from rightward movement). Over recent years, there has been an emergent trend to formalize the CSC not as a (purely) syntactic constraint (as originally formulated by Ross 1967), but as one of interpretation (see Johnson 2009:294; Sportiche 2024 and references therein). More specifically, the CSC is an interpretive (i.e., LF) requirement that mandates that if one conjunct contains a variable, then all conjuncts must contain a variable.[5] This follows straightforwardly given even the simplest formal LF conditions: In the composition of a conjunct, whatever is coordinated is of the logical type λx.P(x). The simple semantics of coordination is given in (6) (from Heim Kratzer 1998).

(6) $[\![and]\!] = \lambda p.\lambda.q.p = q = 1$

In this denotation, p and q must be of the same type–hence, if p = λx.P(x) (types <e,t>), then q must also be of the same type. Two important points arise given this conception of the CSC: (i) CSC should apply to all movements operations that leave behind a variable, regardless of whether that movement is bound by something to the left (=ATB-leftward-movement) or to the right (ATB-rightward-movement, i.e., RNR); and (ii), deleted items (e.g., VP's that have been deleted by VP-ellipsis) are not interpreted as variables. Deleted elements are interpreted as what they are, they just happen to be phonologically unrealized.[6] Putting these two ideas together, the fact that RNR (and ATB-leftward-movement) both appear to be sensitive to the CSC is as strong an argument as one can give that RNR does show sensitivity to at least one Island whose nature is unconcerned with the direction of the filler-gap dependency.

2.1.2 RNR and the Wh-Island Constraint To take another example of a frequently repeated observation is that while *Wh*-movement is sensitive to *Wh*-islands, RNR is not.

(7) (*)What do you wonder who ___ bought ___and tried to find out who sold ___?

(8) Mariana wonders who bought ___ and Samantha tried to find out who sold ___ **XP**.

Wh-Islands of the type in (7) are a type of island subsumed in much work as an instance

[5]If correct, the CSC is not a specific constraint at all, but rather something which follows from the most basic principles of (type-driven) compositional semantics.

[6]Sabbagh 2007:376 observes examples like (i), which appear to involve CSC-violating VP-ellipsis:

(i) Josh read the map carefully, stayed on the trail, and expected that Jamie would too.

of a more general *intervention effect*.[7] Since the literature on intervention effects is quite vast, all I can hope to do here is outline the broader issue relating to it when drawing any serious conclusions from the grammaticality contrast between examples like (7) and (8). As a starting point for this discussion, let us take the *(Defective) Intervention Constraint* from Chomsky (2000, 2001). The part relevant for our purposes is given in (9).

(9) $*...\alpha > \beta > \gamma$
Where (i) > indicates c-command; and
(ii) β and γ match the probe α.

A key insight of the DIC (and its predeccesors such as Rizzi 1990 (Relativized Minimality), Chomsky 1995 (Attract Closest)) is the idea that not all potential interveners are interveners. For β to count as an intervener, it is crucial that both β and γ have some feature, [F], that α is searching for. Given this, the ungrammaticality of (7) is due (at least in part[8]) to the fact that we have a C-probe with–let's say– a [+wh] feature.[9] Within the c-command domain of C[+wh], there are a two *wh*-phrases that have the [+wh] feature as well. Hence, example (7) is ungrammatical owing to the violation of the (D)IC. On the other hand, if there is only one *wh*-phrase (all other phrases are [-wh]), then there is no intervener between C[+wh] and this *Wh*-phrase. This is the case, for example, of ordinary (long-distance) *Wh*-movement.

(10) What do you think (that) Max bought ___?

The main difference between (7) and (10), then, boils down to this: In (7), there is an intervention effect because there are two wh-phrases within the c-command domain of C[+wh], as schematized in (11). Sentence (10) is grammatical, on the other hand, because there is only one wh-phrase within the c-command domain of C[+wh]–i.e., because there is no closer *wh*-phrase that intervenes.

(11) **Intervention Effect / Wh-island:**
...C[+wh]...XP[+wh]...YP[+wh]...

(12) **No Intervention Effect / No Wh-island:**
...C[+wh]...XP[-wh]...YP[+wh]...

Assuming that this is a reasonable way to analyze *wh*-island effects like (7), it should be rather clear when we return to consider RNR that there is no prediction made by this theory that (7) and (10) would *necessarily* have the same grammatical status. Concretely,

[7] See Mayr 2020 and references for an overview. See also, Kotek 2018

[8] Simpler cases involve superiority effects–e.g. **What did who buy?* (see Pestsky 2001). I do not presume that there is some additional configurational factors involved in relative clause islands, but this does not seem particularly pertinent to the discussion until those are firmly established.

[9] The features like [+wh] that I refer to here are mainly for expository convenience only, as this is neither the time nor place to develop them in more detail.

let us suppose that (ATB-)Rightward Movement is 'driven' by a [+focus]-feature[10] on a functional head, F, that lies outside of the coordinate structure. Crucially, and perhaps for independent reasons, the RNR-pivot must typically stand at the right-edge of (each of) the conjunct(s) (i.e., the *Right Edge Restriction*). This condition can be satisfied in one of two ways: (i) by virtue of the rightmost position being the base-generated position of the RNR-pivot; or (ii) by (local) displacement of the RNR-pivot to this position.

(13) ... $\_\_\__1$] Foc YP_1

(14) ... __ XP_1 $\_\_\__1$] F YP_1]

The more interesting case here is (14) (a case like (13) satisfies the DIC trivially since there is no intervener which bears a [+focus]-feature). This scenario would be potentially problematic but only if XP bears an equivalent [+focus]-feature to YP that would make it a potential intervener. Consider the following example, slightly adapted from Wilder (2008).

(15) I invited ___ **into my house** ___] and escorted ___ **into my bedroom** ___] the boy who lives next door.

The potential intervener in each conjunct is the locative phrase, in bold. According to Hartmann (2000) and Fery & Hartmann (2005), this element instantiates *contrastive focus* rather than [+focus] and therefore involves a different set of syntactic, semantic, and prosodic features. As such, the locative phrases from within each conjunct are not in 'competition' with the RNR-pivot for (ATB-)rightward movement (i.e., the former is not an intervener), and no intervention effect is observed.

If the reasoning here is valid, then the broader conclusion that we arrive at, coupled with the discussion of the CSC in Section 2.2.1 is this: Many (perhaps all) of the Islands originally discovered by Ross (1967) amount to more than simple statements of syntactic configurations that may not dominate a trace/copy of a moved element. Ross himself provided just simple descriptions of the islands (on the CSC: "In a conjunct, no constituent may be moved, nor may any element contained within that conjunct be moved out of that conjunct"). As research has moved forward since Ross (1967), many of the islands he originally discussed have been argued to follow from (an interaction of) more general principles of the grammar that have either broadened or narrowed the set of sentences ruled out. As a result of much of this progress, the direction of the filler-gap dependency created by movement is irrelevant, affecting both leftward and rightward movement equally. As a diagnostic for movement, then, the *Wh*-island is not necessarily useful or informative unless intervention effects are controlled for.

2.2 String Vacuous Movement

BNP cite an argument from Able (2004) for rejecting R-ATB-Movement on the basis that:

[10] Although the term 'focus' is used here to in contrastive focus, I assume that whatever feature is relevant contrasts with the orfinary (set) of features relating to focus–i.e., contrast enough so that one does not relate to the other as far as intervention effects are concerned.

"...it is typical of overt movement operations that they lead to changes in word order. RNR, however, is obligatorily order-preserving." Implicit or explicit in this argument is the idea that that the Grammar (or UG) does not allow string-vacuous movement. Responding to suggestions by Ross (1967), Chomsky (1973), and Tarlsden (1980, citing Bresnan 1972) might be prohibited, Clements, McCloskey, Mailing, and Zailing (1983) provide arguments on the basis of Icelandic, Kikuyu, and Irish that string-vacuous movement does indeed exist. A recent demonstration, similar in form to that of Clements et. al. can be found in a recent article by Yuyun Wang (Wang 2024). Specifically, Wang observes that RNR in Mandarin Chinese bleeds the phonological process of tone-sandhi. He provides the following example.

(16) Zhangsan yao mǎi/*mái keshi Lisi bu yao mǎi/*mái wo-de fangzi.
Zhangsan want buy but Lisi not want buy my house
'Zhangsan wants to buy, but Lisi does not want to buy, my house. '

According to Wang's description, the form *mǎi* in the initial conjunct is ungrammatical because a rule of tone-sandhi has over-applied, deleting an L-tone associated with (the underlying LH tone of) the verb for 'buy', leaving only an H-tone. Tone-sandhi applies when a L-tone immediately precedes another L-tone, and although the context for this rules is evidently met here (*keshi* has a L-tone), the rule does not apply. In the second conjunct, the context for tone-sandhi is once again met, but the rule under-applies here. Wang's explanation for this is simple: Since what follows the verb in the second conjuncts is a trace/copy of an element that has undergone (rightward) movement, the verb and its object do not form a (syntactic or prosodic) domain for the rule of tone-sandhi to apply. To put it differently, strings of the form V+DP (Verb+DP) are not all equal, they might be analyzed either as in (17a) or (17b).

(17) a. ✔ Tone-sandhi: $[_{\mathrm{VP}}$ V DP$]$
b. ✘ Tone-sandhi: $[[_{\mathrm{VP}}$ V $t]$ DP$]$

The string in (17a) is a domain where tone-sandhi applies, but the string in (17b) where the verb's DP complement is displaced bleeds the environment for tone-sandhi.

Phonological effects associated with RNR also potentially point to the same conclusion for English when considering sentential main stress. In English, sentence stress (or, nuclear stress) tends to fall on the most embedded (and therefore, typically, the rightmost) phrase of a the sentence. In a typical SVO sentence such as (18), this sentential stress falls on the object (realized on the N).

(18) Amy reviewed that **book**.
(Cf. Amy **reviewed** that book.)

Since (default) sentential stress tends to fall on the most embedded elements in the sentence (see, e.g., Cinque 1993; Selkirik 1995), it is to be expected that in an OV language, sentential stress will fall on the object before the verb rather than after the verb as in English, a

VO language. Kahenemuyiour (2009:75) provides the following example from Persian to illustrate that this is a correct prediction.

(19) Ali [**qazza** xord].
Ali food ate
'Ali eats food.'

Persian presents some additionally relevant facts. In sentence (19), the object is non-specific. Objects that are specific (marked with the ACC marker), still appear before the verb, but sentential stress falls on the verb rather than the object. Consider the example in (20).

(20) Ali qazaa-ro **xord**
Ali food-ACC eat
'Ali ate the food.'

According to Kahenemuyoir (2009), specific objects undergo leftward-movement to a position to the left of and higher than the verb, leaving the verb as the most embedded element of the clause to receive sentential stress. In sentence (20), object shift is string vacuous, though it can be observed more directly in examples like (21) where an adverb comes between the object and the verb.

(21) Ali qazaa-sh-o [**xub** xord]
Ali food-his-ACC well ate
'Ali ate his food well.'

A nearly identical observation can be made for English. When the object is fronted via *Wh*-movement, sentential stress falls on the verb rather than the object.

(22) Which book did Amy **review**?
(Cf. *Which **book** did Amy review?)

Comparing Persian and English, both languages show the same pattern of assignment of sentential stress on the verb when the verb's object is removed from its initial merge position (as complement to the V). Returning to RNR constructions, in addition to the pause separating each conjunct from the other and the entire ConjP from the RNR-pivot, it is also crucial to note that it is the verb (or whatever final element precedes the RNR-pivot) rather than the shared element that receives sentential stress. Selkirk (2002) documents this fact with the following example (example (23a), my example, shows the regular placement of sentential stress in a simplex sentence).

(23) a. Mary buys [pictures of Elvis [**Presley**]].
b. Mary [**buys**], and Bill [**sells**], pictures of Elvis Presley.

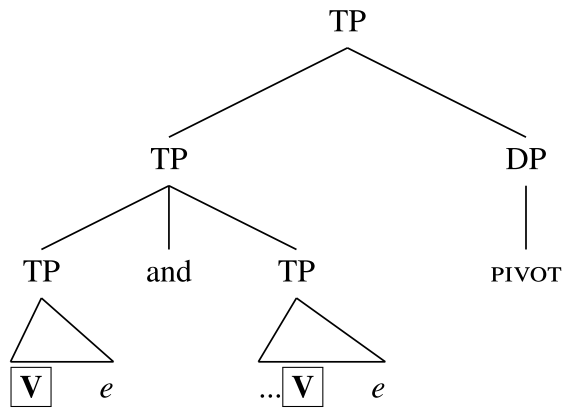
Placing sentence stress on the RNR-pivot is judged to be unnatural.[11]

[11]Unless there is contrastive stress. See Selikirk (2001), Valmala (2013), and any other references on the

(24) *Mary buys and Bill sells [pictures of [Elvis **Presley**]].

The placement and distribution of sentential stress flows naturally from the system developed by Kahenayiupour together with the (rough) structure of a (string-vacuous) movement analysis of RNR.

(25)



If, instead, one were to adopt an *in-situ* analysis for RNR, it may be possible to explain the placement of sentential stress on the verb in the initial conjunct, but not in the second. In other words, assuming the assignment of sentential stress as articulated above–one should expect the distributed of sentential stress indicated in example (26).

(26) *Mary [**buys** *e*] and Bill sells [pictures of [Elvis **Presley**]].

Under 'neutral conditions' where there is nothing (e.g., contrastive stress) to over-ride the placement of sentential stress, example (26) is dubious.

The important take away here is this: Although RNR (viewed as movement) involves string-vacuous movement, this is so if we only consider 'string vacuity' to be a matter of linear order and linear order alone. What I am arguing here–and what others have assumed implicitly or explicitly–is that linear (word) order i just one way to detect an application of Movement. The tone-sandhi rules of Mandarin and the sentential stress rules of English and Persian offer other ways for Movement to be observed. If this is current, then Able's argument (as well as BNP's) dissolved.

2.3 Rebracketing: (Im)Possible Interactions

BLP cite a second argument, again from Able (2004), that RNR cannot be derived by Movement. The argument is this: If RNR is analyzed as (ATB-rightward-)*movement*, there should be a trace left behind by this movement, which can then be re-bracketed with other material (the verb and preposition) of the VP. This VP would be a potential target for the process of VP-ellipsis which would leave behind the RNR-pivot as a 'remnant' that evades being elided along with the VP.

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prosody of RNR.

(27) a. Jane talked about, but Frank didn't talk about, the achievements of the syntax students.

b. (REBRACKETING) ⇒
... Frank didn't [$_{\text{VP}}$ talk about t_1] the achievements of the syntax students$_1$]

c. (VP-ELLIPSIS) ⇒
... *Frank didn't [$_{\text{VP}}$ *e*] the achievements of the syntax students$_1$.

Overlooked in this argument is the fact that ungrammatical examples like (27c) are grammatical in other contexts. Concretely, (27c) resembles the construction known as *Pseudo-gapping*. A (grammatical) instance of pseudo-gapping is given in (28) (from Johnson 2009).

(28) Some have served mussel to Sue while others [$_{\text{AuxP}}$ have [$_{\text{VP}}$ Δ]] swordfish.

As the annotations on (28) attempt to illustrate, pseudo-gapping has been analyzed as involving Movement of a constituent (*swordfish*) out of a VP that has undergone VP-ellispis (see, e.g., Lasnik 1999; Johnson 2009; and many others). It has been observed in much of the literature on pseudo-gapping is that pseudo-gapping generally leads to ungrammaticality when the remnant would strand a preposition (Levine 1979, 1986; Lasnik 1990). Consider example (29).

(29) *John sat beside Bill, and Mary did [$_{\text{VP}}$ Δ] Susan

The ungrammaticality of pseudo-gapping in (29) has been analyzed, at least partially, on a prohibition against preposition stranding under rightward movement (Ross 1967, page). Sentences like (30a), for instance, are typically judged to be ungrammatical when contrasted with examples (30b-c) where no preposition stranding occurs.

(30) a. *John sat behind *yesterday* Bill (and Bill's best friend Mary).

b. John sat beside Bill *yesterday*.

c. John sat *yesterday* behind Bill.

If we control for this confound, the types of examples that according to Able and BNP would be predicted to be grammatical under a movement analysis of RNR (which predicts a*f*example n interaction with VP-ellipsis that allows the RNR-pivot to 'escape' ellipsis) are, in fact, comparatively much better than examples like (30a). Consider the examples in (31).

(31) a. (?)Lotus wanted to try, and not just because Jorger wanted to [$_{\text{VP}}$ Δ] each and every type of chocolate that was being sold in the shop.

b. (?)Fred was willing to discuss, but Max wasn't [$_{\text{VP}}$ Δ] the events that transpired on that chilling evening.

The examples here seem to be acceptable to the extent that speakers presented with them accept them as much as they tolerate pseudo-gapping to begin with. Clapp (2008), who also points out that Able's example involves an illicit instance of pseudo-gapping (relatable to an instance of illicit rightward movement) provides the following example to demonstrate a grammatical interaction between RNR and Ellipsis.

(32) Some would have chosen the reindeer shaped ___, and others would have the Santa-shaped ___ **cookie cutters**.

For this very simple reason, I contend that the ungrammaticality of (30) (and–crucially–(30a)) does not directly implicate RNR. The logic of the argument that a movement analysis of RNR predicts sentence (29) to be ungrammatical follows from independent (though still not understood) restrictions on rightward movement. Additionally, Valma (2013) cites as grammatical an example from Catalan and Spanish that appears to confirm the prediction about the interaction between ellipsis and RNR that BNP state is incorrectly predicted to be grammatical under a movement analysis of RNR. In particular, Valma (2013:237) cites the following example from Catalan (and another from Spanish) involving an RNR-pivot surviving ellipsis (according to her, TP-ellipsis).

(33) L'Anna llegirà i jo probablement també [$_{VP}$ Δ] **tots els teus articles sobre RNR**.
the.Anna read.FUT and I probably too almost the your articles on RNR
'Anna will read, and I probably will too almost all of your papers on RNR.'

Curiously, although BNP cite Valma's work in their references, they make no specific reference to this example which is quite critical to their argument. To conclude this section, then, BNP's argument (or rather, Able's argument) from *rebracketing* is either inconclusive (representing, as they do, an instance of an independently ungrammatical case of *pseud-gapping*) and/or–more seriously–contra-indicated by Valma's evidence from Catalan and Spanish as well as the English sentences in (31)-(32). Re-bracketing, therefore, does not force one to the conclusion that a movement analysis of RNR should be dismissed (see Section 3.1 for further discussion).

2.4 Mismatches

In recent years, much work on the topic of RNR has focussed on a phenomenon which may broadly be called, *mismatch effects*. These are typically morpho-syntactic in nature and center around cases where (i) the shared element has a grammatically licit (morph-syntactic) relationship with an element of one conjunct but not the other; or (ii) where an element (e.g., a verb) within one of of the conjuncts but not the other exhibits inflection that is predicted on the basis of the features associated with the pivot. BNP cite example (34) to illustrate the nature of the phenomenon.

(34) I usually fail to, but Ava always succeeds in, waking up early.

The RNR-pivot, *waking up early*, exhibits the appropriate inflection relative to the final conjunct but not the first. In particular, 'reconstruction' of the pivot into the initial conjunct would correspond to example (35), which is plainly ungrammatical.

(35) *I usually fail to *waking up early*.

Mismatches of this kind, as noted by BLP, are quite common and grammatical with process like VP-ellipsis.

(36) Ava always succeeds in waking up early, but I usually fail to [$_{\text{VP}}$ *e*].
e = *waking up early*

The logic of the argument against a movement analysis based on this paradigm is (deceptively) simple: Since VP-ellipsis allows (various types of) inflectional mismatch, as shown in (36), and since the RNR sentence in (34) involves the exact same inflectional mismatch, RNR can only be derived by a process like VP-ellipsis rather than Movement or (in-situ) Multiple-dominance. Crucially, the reasoning here depends upon the presumption that uncontroversial instances of (leftward) Movement would never allow verbal mismatch of this kind. I believe this is incorrect. VP's in English may undergo topicalization or (*it*-)Clefting, as in (37).

(37) It's [$_{\text{VP}}$ waking up too early] that I can't stand ___.

While the gap in (37) could, I presume, be analyzed as a form of VP-ellipsis rather than VP-movement, I am unaware of any analysis of examples of it involving VP-ellipsis. If the position occupied by the VP in (37) is derived by Movement, then it is informative to note that ATB-movement appears (to my ear, at least) to tolerate a comparable type of mismatch as does (34). Consider the following example.

(38) It's [waking up early] that I usually fail to, but Ava always succeeds in.

A even more extreme case is (37), which contain the pleonastic *do* in place of the initial VP.

(39) [Waking up early] is what I usually fail to <u>do</u>, but Ava always succeeds in <u>doing</u>.

In place of a null VP (derived either by movement or deletion), *do* in these examples seems to have the familiar 'supportive' function. If the VP were to be reconstructed as the complement of *do*, there would be a mismatch in both conjuncts: **...is what I fail to do waking up early but Ava always succeeds in doing waking up early*. If *do* stands in for VP, as seems plausible, then its form in the second conjunct is matched, but not so for the *do* in the initial conjunct (cf., **Waking up early is what I usually fail to doing.*).

Now, one might reasonably argue that examples like (38) involve an 'illusion' of grammaticality akin to the ungrammatical but acceptable to most examples of *the keys to the door are/is on the table*. This may be so, but then the same should be true of examples of RNR like (34) as well, and no definitive conclusion can reasonably follow from it concerning the proper analysis of RNR.

2.4.1 Licensing Conditions on Ellipsis There is a different kind of issue raised by examples of verbal mismatch in RNR that has, to my knowledge, never been acknowledged by authors who present such examples as an (unresolvable) problem for movement analyses of RNR.

The issue is this: Ellipsis, VP-ellipsis in particular, is known to be subject to a *licensing* condition that is rather idiosycratic and variable cross-linguistically. To get a sense of what this means, consider VP-ellipsis in English. While virtually all speakers of English allow a VP to be *licensed* when it is a sister to the progressive auxiliary/copula verb *be*, there is some variation when it comes to VP-ellipsis when a VP is a sister to the perfective auxiliary (see, e.g., (references)) .

(40) a. John has been winning medals long before you have been.
b. John has been winning medals long before you have been [$_{\mathrm{VP}}$ winning medals].
c. %John has been winning medals long before you have [$_{\mathrm{ProgP}}$ been winning medals].

Consider again the RNR example (34), which BNP argue militates against a movement or an (in-situ) multiple dominance but supports an analysis as (VP-)ellipsis. What BNP do not consider, however, is the (plain) fact that VP-ellipsis is not licensed as sister to things like *succeed in* in any other context. The (severe) ungrammaticality of example (b) examples in (41) (which involve ellipsis) compared to the (c) examples (which involve movement) make this point quite clear.

(41) a. Will you be waking up early?
b. *I'll try, but I almost never succeed in [$_{\mathrm{VP}}$ Δ].
c. How early did you succeed in waking up ___?

(42) a. Was Mark playing with the rifles?
b. *No, because it's dangerous to [$_{\mathrm{VP}}$ Δ] for everyone around him.
c. (Its) Waki(ng) up early that I always thought it was dangerous to ___.

According to Merchant (see also, References; Alebrecht 2015, Thoms 2015), there is presently no 'deep' theory of which head do, and which do not, license Ellipsis of their complements. Instead, this 'irregularity' simply has to be stipulated–specifically, some heads have an [E]-feature (which licenses ellipsis), while others do not. Which heads have this feature and which ones do not must be learned on a language particular and/or cross-linguistic basis (e.g., some languages–German, for example–have Sluicing (=TP-ellipsis) but apparently lack VP-ellipsis.

The fact that an empty category in the form of a trace is licensed in (c) examples, but a putative case of VP-ellipsis in (b) examples is not, would seem to favor a movement analysis for RNR over an analysis in terms of Ellipsis. I will not dwell on or develop this line of argumentation, but rather note that it involves the exact same logic that BNP use to favor of RNR being derived by Ellipsis over one involving Movement. In short, no definitive conclusion can truly drawn here.

2.5 Vehicle Change

Very briefly, BNP provide an example of RNR that appears to involve *Vehicle Change*, in which a proper name is treated for purposes of interpretation and grammaticality as if it were a pronoun (Fiengo & May 1994). Fiengo & May (1994) provide the following examples.[12]

(43) She$_1$ hopes that he won't, but I fear that the boss will, fire Ava$_1$.

BNP's argument seems to be this: Since *Vehicle Change* is an attested property of (VP-)ellipsis, the fact that (44) is grammatical (because Vehicle Change obviates Principle C), examples like (44) must be derived by VP-ellipsis. This argument, like the ones above is based on an implicit assumption that Vehicle Change is only possible with ellipsis. Safir (1998:604-608), however, has argued that Vehicle Change is not an exclusive property of VP-ellipsis, but that it applies to Ā-Movement as well– specifically, to traces (copies) of Ā-Movement. One of his arguments is based on the observation that the operation of Vehicle Change, as proposed by Fiengo & May (1994:218-224), can apply to proper names but not to quantified noun phrases. Safir's insights and proposal are motivated independently of any concern for RNR, but never the less can be applied to provide an analysis of (44) consistent with a movement analysis. Specifically, assuming a movement analysis of RNR, reconstruction of the RNR-pivot *fire Ava* yields the representation in (45b), to which vehicle change applies to yield the representation (45c).

(44) a. She$_1$ hopes that he won't, but I fear that the boss will, fire Ava$_1$.
b. She$_1$ hopes that he won't [fire *Ava*], but I fear that the boss will [fire *Ava*$_1$].
c. She$_1$ hopes that he won't [fire *her*$_1$], but I fear that the boss will [fire *her*$_1$].

Crucially, if Safir is correct–that vehicle change does not apply to quantified noun phrases–then we predict (correctly) that (46a) will not have the interpretation in (46b), where the pronoun is interpreted as a bound variable pronoun associated with the (quantificational) RNR-pivot. This seems to be correct. (46b) is not an available interpretation for (46ba). Instead, the only interpretation is one represented in (46c).

(45) a. She hopes that he won't, but I fear that the boss will, fire every woman (who demands equal pay).
b. She$_i$ hopes that he won't, but I fear that the boss will, fire every woman$_i$ (who demands equal pay).
c. She$_1$ hopes that he won't [fire *fire every woman*], but I fear that the boss will [fire *every woman*].

My point here, to be clear, is simply to point out that if Safir's proposal (justified independently of any consideration of RNR) is correct–that Vehicle Change may apply to copies of Movement just as it can for Ellipsis (also, justified independently of RNR)–then once again no definitive conclusion can be reached concerning the proper analysis of RNR (as Movement or Ellipsis) like (44).

2.6 Interim Summary

At this point, I have addressed five out of the six of the empirical challenges that militate

[12] See Levine (1985), who was the first, to my knowledge, to report on this fact.

against a movement analysis of RNR cited by BNP. My replies to these challenges is that each of them are insufficient (separately or collectively) to justify the abandonment of a movement analysis, and that a movement analysis deserves just as much consideration as the other mainstream analyses of RNR (i.e. Ellipsis and/or Multiple dominance). Within this context, it is important to note two things that this work does not do (as it was not intended to): I have not developed or defended any *specific* analysis of RNR couched in terms of movement. Sabbagh(2007) is the only work, as far as I am aware, to do so. I neither intended to defend the specific details of his analysis (involving Cyclic Spell-Out, Fox & Pesetsky's order preservation, etc.). In fact, work on RNR could greatly benefit if scholars were to ask the question: What specific details of Sabbagh's analysis work, and which ones do not (see Abe and Hornstein 2012 for such a discussion)? In other words, if we take seriously the possibility that RNR might be derived by Movement, work can begin to proceed on addressing the question of what such an analysis might look like in. modern theoretical context instead of taking Ross' 1967 analysis as a representative for such an analysis.[13] My goal in this article begins there and finishes here with that goal in mind (more or less, though see Section 3). Having argued (successfully, I hope) that the 'empirical challenges' raised by BNP do not pose an inherent road black to pursuing a movement analysis of RNR, serious and lively debate can take place within the context of a movement analysis, rather than where the field is now in implicitly or explicitly summarily rejecting such an analysis (as in BNP's quote from earlier).

Taking stock, recall BNP's Table 1 from the introduction to this section. If the remarks above accomplished their intended goal, then the empirical coverage of the Movement analysis with regards to (a)-(e) can be converted from ✘'s (does not explain/is incompatible with the facts) to ✔'s (is compatible with the data).

		Movement
a.	Order preservation	✘ → ✔
b.	Island insensitivity	✘ → ✔
c.	Non-rebracketing	✘ → ✔
d.	Mismatches	✘ → ✔
e.	Vehicle change	✘ → ✔
f.	Internal readings	?

We have not yet discussed the issue of internal readings. Early on in their discussion (BNP 2023:691), they use '?' in their table when comparing the empirical coverage of different unary and dual analysis, presumably indicating uncertainty about whether a movement analysis is compatible with the facts from this domain. A bit later on in their discussion (pp. 710), however, this ? is converted to ✘ for reasons that I will discuss in the next section where I will also sketch out a Movement+Multiple-dominance analysis for RNR that, to my knowledge, has yet to be considered in light of recent theoretical advances.

[13]To be quite fair, this is a problem for other analyses as well. For example, most authors who adopt an ellipsis analysis typically presuppose that what all such an analysis entails is either known and accepted, or left to others to develop.

3 Scope, Movement, and Multiple Dominance

What BNP refer to as 'Internal readings' is actually a cover term for an array of independent facts indicating that scope-bearing RNR-pivots are interpreted as having wide scope over the coordinate structure. The term 'Internal reading' refers specifically to an observation by Carlson (1987) that noun phrases such as *the same book/a different book* may have an external or an internal reading. The external reading, as the name suggests, refers to some contextually salient book. The internal interpretation, on the other hand, is one in which *the same/different NP* is distributed over events.

This contrast can be seen rather clearly by comparing (47), which has only an external reading, with (48), which permits the internal reading.

(46) Freddy read the same book *once*.

(47) Freddy read the same book *twice*.

Now consider the example of RNR in (48a), in which *the same book..* is the RNR-pivot. The internal interpretation is paraphrased in (48b), which may be compared to the external reading paraphrased in (48c), which is hard to come by given that composition of a song usually typically precedes the performance of it.

(48) *Internal Readings of 'same/different':*
  a. Ava composed and Beatrix performed, the same song.
  b. INTERNAL READING: The song$_3$ that Ava composed and Beatrix performed is a song, s_i, s.t., and Ava and Beatrix composed and performed s_i and i $\neq \{1, 2\}$.
  c. EXTERNAL READING: There was a song$_1$ such that that Ava composed it$_1$ and Beatrix sang it$_1$.
  (Jackendoff 1977, Carlson 1987)

Other instances of scope-bearing RNR-pivot include examples like (50), where the RNR-pivot is a universally quantified noun phrase and the subject of each of the conjuncts is an existentially quantified noun phrase. As Sabbagh (2007:365-367) observes the pivot has the possibility of the wide scope reading paraphrased in (50b).

(49) *Wide Scope for 'every'*:
  a. A professor stole or a student borrowed every book on the shelf.
  b. WIDE/CONJUNCT EXTERNAL INTERP.: Every book on the shelf is such that either a professor stole them or a student borrowed them.
  c. NARROW/CONJUNCT INTERNAL INTERP.: Either a professor stole every book on the shelf or a student stole every book on the shelf
  (Sabbagh 2007, Bacharach & Katzir 2007, 2009)

Finally, Hirsch & Wagner (2015) observe that when *only* is associated with an RNR-pivot, the pivot may have wide scope with respect to the coordinate structure. They offer the example in (51).

(50) *Wide Scope for ‘only’*:

a. John likes and Mary hates only the Fantastic Mr. Fox

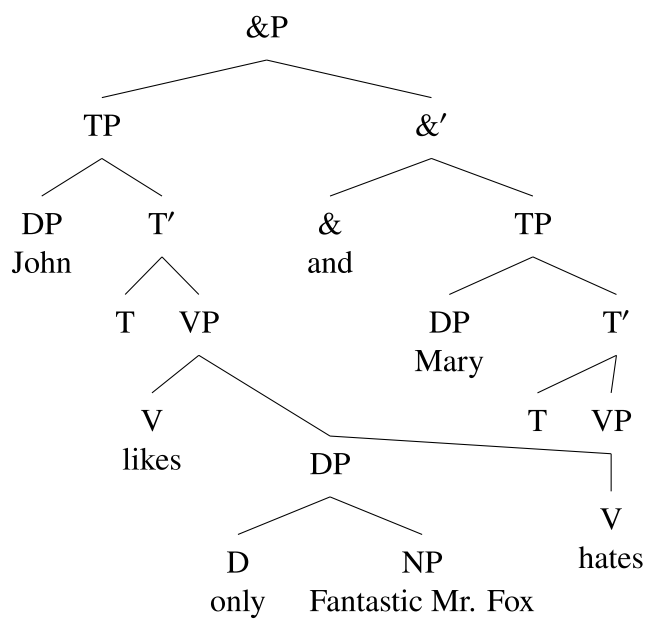
b. WIDE/CONJUNCT EXTERNAL INTERP.: Fantastic Mr. Fox is the one film that both John likes and Mary hates. (i.e., for all other films, the ones that John likes are in complementary distribution with the films that Mary hates.)

c. NARROW/CONJUNCT INTERNAL INTERP.: Fantastic Mr. Fox is the one film that John like and the one film that Mary hates.
(Hirsch and Wagner 2015)

The relevance of these facts for the proper analysis of RNR should be straightforward. As authors who have cited or contributed to these facts acknowledge, the wide scope interpretations require a representation for the RNR sentences in which the RNR-pivot is external to the coordinate structure. Moreover, different authors have responded in different ways to this need. BNP, who adopt the dual analysis to RNR advocated in Barros & Vicente (2011) involving both Ellipsis and Multiple-Dominance, suggest that the wide scope interpretations could involve a representation involving a multiple dominance syntax to which movement applies *covertly* (BNP:699, see also Abe & Hornstein 2012). This is an intriguing suggestion, which I will explore in the remainder of these remarks.

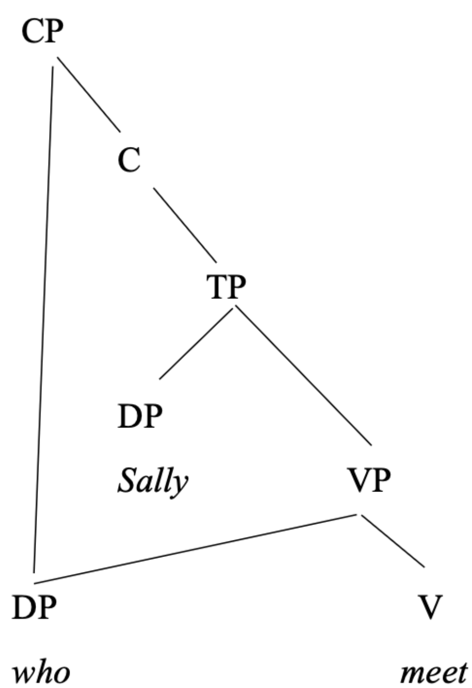
BNP’s suggestion that wide scope interpretations could involve covert movement of the shared RNR pivot suggests, at the very least, that BNP see no inherent contradiction in the possibility that a shared (multi-dominated) constituent (as represented in (52)) may undergo movement.

(51)



Presumably, then, the reason they are inclined to suggest covert rather than overt movement for the pivot is based on the reasoning that a movement analysis is ill-equipped to cover the rage of empirical facts discussed in Section 2. If we assume that those issues have been addressed and are no longer an impediment to a movement analysis, we might begin sketching out what an analysis of RNR looks like that involves multiple dominance and movement. Before we do this, some points of clarification are called form: First, many authors when they refer to multiple dominance as an analysis of RNR seem to equate this with an analysis that is inherently also an *in-situ* analysis of RNR. Current theorizing on *multidominant syntax* (to use Citko & Gračanin-Yusksek's (2020) term) is not only consistent with movement, it is a (if not the) key component of a theory of the how movement is represented. According to the theory developed in Ctiko & Gracanin-Ysakek (see also Zhang 2004), even simple instances of displacement are represented in terms of multiple dominance.

(52)



Within the contemporary theoretical landscape, (53) is simply a representation of the process of *internal merge*–a subtype of the more general structure-building process known as *Merge* (Chomsky 2001).

(53) *Merge:*
  a. **External:** Merge(A, B), where neither A nor B dominates the other;
  b. **Internal:** Merge(A, B), where B is dominated by a node that dominated by A's sister.

The only new concept added to this picture is what Citok & Gracin-Yuksek term *parallel* *merge*, which allows an element A to be (externally) merged with distinct elements–e.g., two different verbs as in (52). The resulting system, then, derives what is classically known as Across-the-Board (ATB-)movement.

Note that the wide-scope interpretations observed with respect to examples (49)-(51) fall out from this system, either as an instance of overt movement (=the higher position is pronounced) or as covert movement (=the lower position is pronounced). Significantly, what is outlined here is not a 'dual analysis' of RNR involving a representation involving movement for some instances of RNR, multiple-dominance for others. Any apparent duality is just that, apparent–as multiple dominance under this view is the major mode of derivation and representation of movement.

3.1 A Residue of Ellipsis?

In a short but influential paper, Barros & Vicente (2011) argued, on the basis of essentially all of the same set of facts reviewed in this article, that a theory of RNR (for English) requires both Ellipsis and Multiple Dominance. Barros & Vicente's work on RNR is the first, to my knowledge, to proposes such a 'dual analysis' of RNR. BNP conclude the same. As I attempted to make clear, the analysis of RNR that I sketched out above is not a dual analysis of RNR. Before I offer my concluding remarks, I'd like to consider whether there is any role for Ellipsis in the analysis of RNR. The focus of this discussion will the the matching effects initially raised in Section 2.4-2.5.

BNP leave a role for Ellipsis in their analysis of RNR to account for the mismatch and vehicle change effects discussed in sections 2.4 and 2.5, respectively.[14] One could imagine many other types of mismatch effects. The reason mismatch effects requires ellipsis in addition to multi-dominance, according to Barros & Vicente and BNP is that Ellipsis analysis, but not the Multiple Dominance analysis would seem to require there to be two independent occurrences of the share element–identical in many respects except one or two features/properties, or the 'sharing' of a feature/property among the two occurrences even if the shared feature is not grammatically appropriate for one of these. In their words: "...multidominance imposes an absolute identity requirement on the pivot and the "gap": they are literally the same constituent." For this reason, BNP adopt a 'dual' (Multidominance analysis of some RNR case, Ellipsis analysis for others) analysis of RNR and assume that cases of mismatch are accounted for via the two occurrence structure that an Ellipsis analysis provides.

BNP's claim that "multidominance imposes an absolute identity requirement on the pivot", though it may seem intuitively correct, does not actually follow from anything. In other words, their work does not specifically articulate a theory of multidominance in which this requirement is somehow 'built in' to the whatever system allows for representations that include multidominance to be generated in the first place (nor do they refer to any work that explicitly does so). In fact, instances of mismatch (not discussed in BNP) involving conflicting case requirements of a shared DP can, arguably, be dealt with naturally with a multidominance structure. Consider one such case, from Korean (Kim et. al. 2023:134).

[14] Vehicle change is arguably best thought of as a sub-class of mismatch effects.

(54) **Kheyikhu-lul** John-i [___ mantul-ko] Mary-ka [___ mekessta].
cake-ACC John-NOM make-and Mary-NOM ate
'The cake, John made and Mary ate.'

Kheyiku-lul ('cake') is a shared argument of the verbs meaning 'make' and 'eat'. The former verb under ordinary cases would assign DAT, while the latter assigns accusative case. The realization of the shared element represents an instance of mismatch relating to case. Not all languages allow case-mismatches of this sort for ATB-dependencies. Citko (2005) and Citko & Gračanin-Uksek (2020) show that in Polish mismatches in case are impossible for ATB-*Wh*-movement. Consider the examples in (56).

(55) a. **Kogo** Jan lubi ___ a Maria podziwia ___?
who.ACC Jan likes and Maria admires
'Who does Jan like and Maria admire?'

b. ***Kogo/Komu** Jam lubi ___ a Maria ufa ___?
who.ACC/DAT Jan likes and Maria trusts
'Who does Jan like and Maria trust?'

Citko (2005) cites the comparative grammaticality of the examples in (56) as evidence for her specific approach to ATB-movement based on parallel merge (=multidominance). However, if this is correct and based on the same reasoning stated explicitly by BNP (that "multidominance imposes an absolute identity requirement on the pivot"), then the Korean example in (55) poses a puzzle which leads us to one of two possible conclusions–either: (i) Examples like (55) in Korean are derived by Ellipsis, while the closely analogous Polish examples involve a multidomance structure; or (ii) Korean and Polish utilize multidominance structures to derive ATB-dependencies, but multidomance does not *inherently* impose an absolute identity requirement on the pivot. On the latter view, we might then suggest that there is variation among languages in the extent to which they allow a multidominated shared constituent to tolerate (and resolve) conflicting morphosyntactic requirements (i.e., whether they allow mismatch or not).

Although this question cannot be resolved let alone explored in more detail here than a few remarks, there is possible good reason for pursuing the latter possibility that I would like to conclude by mentioning. In particular, mismatch effects not unlike what we see for the Korean ATB-dependency in (55) have been observed and rather extensively studied in the context of Free Relative Clauses (Groos & van Reimsdjik 1981; Harbert 1938; Hirchbuler 1976; van Reimsdjik 2000; 2006a,b,c; Vogel 2001). Bergsma (2019:29-31), referencing Harbert (1978:339, 434), provides the following example from Gothic. Note that the free-relative pronoun (boxed) realizes the case-morphology based on what is assigned to it by the verb (in bold) within the relative clause.

(56) ushafjands ana $\boxed{\text{þamm-ei}}$ **lag**
picking.up on DAT-COMP lay
'picking up that on which he lay'

In what Vogel refers to as 'less complex free relatives', the case that is realized on the relative pronoun is the case assigned to the free relative clause by the verb that is external to the free relative.[15]

(57) hva nu wileiþei taujau þamm-ei qiþpiþ udan Iudaie?
what now want that do DAT-COM say king of.Jews
'What now want do you wish that I do to him whom you call king of Jews?'

In Polish, by contrast, mismatch is impossible (Bergsma 2019:31-32, citing Citko 2013). Hence, example (59) is grammatical but the examples in (60) are not.

(58) Jan unija kojto dojde prav.
Jan avoids whoever.ACC yesterday offended
'Jan avoided whoever he offended yesterday,'

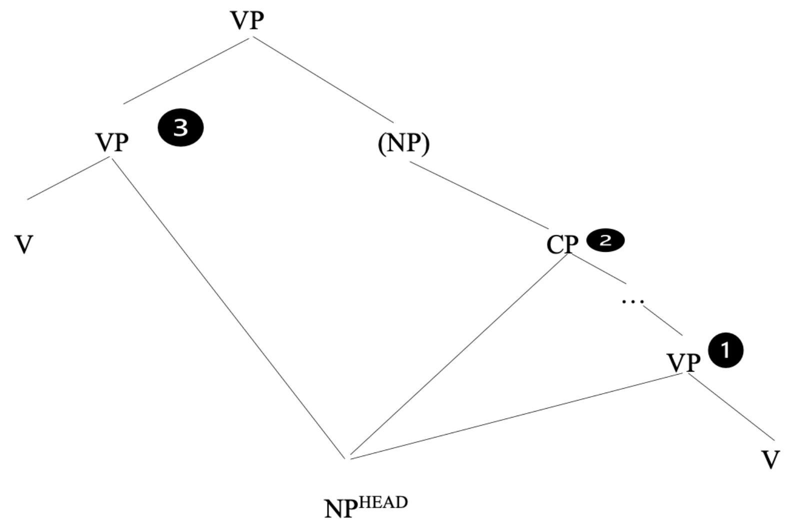
(59) a. *Jan lubi kogokolwiek/komukolwiek dokucza.
Jan likes whoever.ACC/whoever.DAT teases
Juan likes whoever he teases.'

b. *Jan ufa kogokolwiek/komukolwiek wpuścil do domu.
Jan trusts whoever.ACC/whoever.DAT let to home
'Jan trusts whoever he let into the house.'

van Riemsjik (2006 ibid.) proposes a structural anlalysis of free relative clauses that serves as the scaffolding for analyses that account for the kind of morpho-syntactic variation exhibited by comparison of languages like Gothic and Polish. His analysis, which makes use of the primitives of current syntactic theory, is couched within a derivation that invokes what he refers to as *Grafting*. van Riemsdjik's grafting yields a representation for free relative clause that can be equivalently stated in terms of the system of multi-dominant syntax of Citko that invokes a combination of primitive processes of (internal/external, and parallel) Merge. A syntax for free relatives derived from these structure building operations may be as illustrated in (61).

[15] See references cited in main text for detailed analysis of which case (=the one of the relative clause, or the verb that selects it, determines the case of the relative pronoun).

(60)



Supposing this is correct, note that it ought to be able to accommodate the kind of variation we see concerning whether it allows mismatches of the kind we find in Copic or does not allow them as we find for Polish (see Bergsma 2019 for a proposal). It also entails, and most crucially for our purposes, that Multiple-dominance does not enforce 'absolute identity' on a multi-dominated shared constituent, contra what is claimed in BNP's work. If so, the need for Ellipsis to account for cases of mismatches dissolves, including–I would assume–not only for instances of mismatch related to case but also to the kinds of verbal (inflectional) mismatch discussed in Section 2.4.

4 Conclusion

This article has offered a rebuke of the most commonly cited arguments against an analysis of RNR in which the construction is derived, as originally envisaged by Ross (1967), by Across the Board rightward movement. I have argued, in particular, that none of these arguments carry they same force as they might seem to have had when first made. Since then, many developments in the field have broadened our understanding among many domains (e.g., islands, reconstructions, syntax-morphology mismatches, and so on) rendering some of the facts from these domains either irrelevant or inconclusive as diagnostics that help to adjudicate among different analysis for RNR. Finally, I have sketched out a 'path forward' in re-conceiving what a movement analysis might look like given current ways of representing movement in terms of a multidomiant syntax. The timing is ripe, therefore for movement analysis of RNR to be (re)considered and treated as equally viable as others as research on this construction endures.

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